

Task 1

Title: The Han Empire: A Golden Age of China (206 BCE – 220 CE)

Founding & Structure: Established by Emperor Gaozu (Liu Bang) after the Qin collapse. It perfected a centralized, bureaucratic government administered by Confucian scholars.

Expansion & Trade: Expanded Chinese territory and secured the Silk Road, facilitating trade and cultural exchange from China to the Roman Empire.

Cultural & Technological Flourishing: This era saw major innovations, including the invention of paper, advanced water clocks, the seismoscope, and significant historical records by Sima Qian.

Enduring Legacy: The Han Dynasty solidified the foundational cultural and ethnic identity of China. The term “Han Chinese” is still used today, reflecting its profound and lasting impact.

Task 2

1. Who wrote the paper? Smith, J., & Chen, L.
2. What is the paper about? The paper analyzes the impact of cross-cultural communication styles on international business negotiations.
3. When was the paper published? It was published in 2023.
4. Where was the paper published? It was published in the Journal of International Business Studies.
5. Why did the author(s) write the paper? The authors wrote it to identify common communication barriers and provide a framework for more effective intercultural negotiations.

Task 3: Summary of Chapters 3 & 4 of "The Joy Luck Club"

Chapter 3, "The Red Candle," is Lindo Jong's story of her past in China. She recounts her arranged childhood marriage to Huang Tyan-yu. Lindo describes how, despite being sent to live with the Huang family and being treated like a servant, she maintained a strong sense of her own internal worth. The pivotal moment is her ingenious plan to escape the marriage without dishonoring her parents; she invents a story about her ancestor's ghost visiting her and predicting disaster for her husband if she stays. This cleverly persuades the Huang family to release her, allowing her to travel to America and reclaim her own life.

Chapter 4, "The Moon Lady," is Ying-ying St. Clair's story, told from her daughter Lena's perspective. Ying-ying recalls a traumatic childhood event in China when, during the Moon Festival, she fell off a boat and was separated from her family. She was rescued and, for a brief moment, saw the real "Moon Lady" on a stage—a tragic and abandoned figure. This event symbolizes her loss of innocence and the beginning of a pattern of passivity and disconnection from her own desires that has defined her life, first in her failed first marriage and later in her relationship with her American husband.

Together, these two chapters explore the theme of identity and female agency within a traditional cultural context. While Lindo uses her cunning to actively escape an oppressive situation and forge a new destiny, Ying-ying's experience leaves her "ghostly" and trapped by the memory of an early loss. Both stories, however, lay the groundwork for the conflicts and connections that their American-born daughters will experience, showing how the mothers' pasts profoundly shape their daughters' present.